Grammar



Degrees of Comparison

Comparison can be made using the three forms of an adjective.

Adjective is a word that describes or qualifies a noun. It gives more information about a noun.

(e.g.) The tiger is a strong animal.

There are three degrees of comparison

(1) Positive (e.g.) Kumar is a kind man.

(2) Comparative (e.g.) Tsunami is more destructive than Cyclone.

(3) Superlative (e.g.) Mount Everest is the highest peak in the world.

Read the following examples.

Positive	Comparative	Superlative
No other girl in the class is as tall as Ramya.	Ramya is taller than any other girl in the class.	Ramya is the tallest girl in the class.
Very few girls in the class are as tall as Ramya.	Ramya is taller than most other girls in the class.	Ramya is one of the tallest girls in the class.

The Positive Degree is used to express or describe a quality.

The Positive Degree of an adjective states the characteristic of the noun.

(e.g.) It is a tall building.

(e.g.) Mango is sweet to taste.

The Comparative Degree is used when two things (or two sets of things) are compared.

(e.g.) This building is taller than any other building.

(e.g.) Mango is sweeter than pineapple.

The **Superlative Degree** is used when more than two things are compared.

(e.g.) This is the tallest building.

(e.g.) Mango is the sweetest fruit.

Examples

Prabhu is young. (Positive Degree)

Prabhu is younger than Amirtha. (Comparative Degree)

Prabhu is the youngest of all. (Superlative Degree)

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